Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **وزير الاتصالات: تصدر مصر ترتيب الدول الأفريقية في سرعة الإنترنت الثابت على مدار 6 سنوات متتالية** — تفصيلة (Tafsela), 21 October 2026 EGYPT

  At the Egypt Forum's Digital Egypt session, the communications minister set targets for 2030: 400 services on the Digital Egypt platform, fibre to 55% of homes, 5G coverage everywhere and five to seven very large data centres. He also said Egypt has led Africa on fixed internet speed for six years running. The targets are ministerial statements, not a published plan. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov, Connectivity, Data Storage and Digital sovereignty.*

- **UBOS rejects new national data strategy, labels ICT Ministry launch 'illegal' and 'redundant'** — The Independent (Uganda), 21 October 2026 UGANDA

  The Uganda Bureau of Statistics publicly rejected the ICT ministry's National Data Strategy on 21 October 2026, a day after its launch, calling it illegal, irregular and redundant. Its executive director said the strategy breaches the UBOS Act, which makes the Bureau the coordinator of the National Statistical System, and that existing statistics plans already cover its ground. *Also under National statistics.*

- **GouvNum : faire de la donnée et de l'intelligence artificielle des leviers de souveraineté numérique, de rationalisation budgétaire et de transformation de l'État** — Socialnetlink, 21 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Policy analyst Elhadji Wack Ndiaye argues that GouvNum, Senegal's digital government agency, should use data and AI to cut spending and target social programmes under the 2027 finance bill. The budget figures he cites are his own reading of the bill. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking and AI.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Somalia's House of the People Approves the Digital Transactions Bill with 137 Votes in Favour** — Ministry of Communications and Technology, Somalia (via Africa Newsroom), 21 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Somalia's House of the People passed the Digital Transactions Bill on 21 October 2026 with 137 votes in favour, giving a legal framework to digital transactions and mobile money. The bill was drafted by the communications ministry; the release does not mention the Senate stage or assent. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Signature électronique de l'État : la Guinée accélère sa marche vers le zéro papier et la souveraineté numérique** — Guinéenews, 21 October 2026 GUINEA

Guinea opened a workshop in Conakry on 21 October 2026 to review nine draft regulations on the state's electronic signature, following an implementing decree adopted on 19 August 2026. The justice ministry is adapting procedure texts to bring e-signatures into a future procedure code, and the digital agency ANDE is building the public-key infrastructure behind them. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Minister promises 'revised' draft of crypto assets regulation** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 October 2026
  SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's finance minister said on 21 October 2026, presenting the Medium-Term Budget Policy Statement, that the draft Capital Flow Management Regulations, which cover cross-border crypto assets, need a different approach after Treasury received thousands of comments. Consultations will produce a revised second draft for further comment; no date was given. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Going digital: Why MPs want land succession done digitally through E-Citizen** — Daily Nation, 21 October 2026
  KENYA

  Kenya's National Assembly Public Petitions committee recommended amending the Law of Succession Act and related laws so that land succession can be handled through e-Citizen and Huduma Centres. It backs a petition to end paper-based trips to land registries and courts. *Also under Registries and Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **32 African markets tax digital services** — ITWeb Africa, 21 October 2026 AFRICA

  PwC's 2026 report on VAT and digital services in Africa finds 32 of 54 countries now tax electronic services supplied by foreign providers, up from 21 in its 2024 edition. The eleven newcomers include Algeria, Botswana, Malawi, Mauritius, Rwanda and Zanzibar, and Namibia and Mozambique have measures awaiting a start date.

Data protection

- **Nigeria's Data Protection Audit Return: Blessing Udo advocates emulation** — BusinessDay, 21 October 2026
  NIGERIA

  Lawyer Blessing Udo argues that Nigeria's annual data protection compliance audit return is a model for other countries, because it makes designated organisations report on their compliance before a breach happens. She compares it favourably with the Californian, Indian, Chinese and EU approaches and calls for findings to be published by sector. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **DPC warns against disclosure of evacuated Ghanaians' personal data** — Ghana News Agency, 21 October 2026
  GHANA

  The Ghana News Agency's account of the Data Protection Commission's warning against publishing the personal details of 1,964 Ghanaians evacuated from South Africa. The statement is summarised under the Commission's own item of 20 October 2026.

- **Bunge committee invites views on data protection** — Daily News (Tanzania), 21 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania's Parliamentary Standing Committee on Infrastructure invited public views on ratifying the AU's Malabo Convention on cybersecurity and personal data protection. It holds a public hearing on 26 October 2026 and accepts written submissions before the ratification resolution moves on. *Also under Regional collaboration and Cybersecurity.*

Regional collaboration

- **Bunge committee invites views on data protection** — Daily News (Tanzania), 21 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Standards

- **SABS publishes draft AI standards for public comment** — Polity, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The South African Bureau of Standards published draft AI standards for comment, each an unmodified adoption of an ISO/IEC text, covering transparency, data quality, human oversight, and AI's benefits and environmental impact. The standards are voluntary unless a law refers to them, and comments close on 10 November 2026. *Also under AI.*

- **NIBSS, Transactility's partnership delivers National Payment Stack** — Premium Times, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Transactility says NIBSS built Nigeria's National Payment Stack, an ISO 20022 instant payments platform, on its open-source jPOS software and jPTS switch. NIBSS says having the full source code leaves it in control of the platform's design, roadmap and intellectual property. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **TikTok blackout hits northern parts of Nigeria** — Connecting Africa, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA

  TikTok has been hard to reach for more than a month in northern states including Kano, Kaduna, Katsina, Kebbi and Sokoto, mostly for MTN and Airtel subscribers. TikTok denies restricting access, the operators have not commented and the government has said nothing. Gatefield's chief executive alleges throttling ahead of the 2027 elections. *Also under Access to services and Connectivity.*

- **IJG pitches mobile savings** — Market Watch Namibia, 21 October 2026 NAMIBIA

  An IJG Investment Managers director proposed a USSD service that would let low-income Namibians put small sums into regulated funds from a basic phone. The service is a prototype, and he asked NAMFISA, the Bank of Namibia and CRAN to let it be tested in a regulatory sandbox. *Also under Access to services and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **Building Artificial Intelligence Capabilities for Eritrea's Development: Reflections from UN Day 2026** — Shabait (Eritrea Ministry of Information), 21 October 2026 ERITREA

  A UN Day panel in Asmara on 15 October discussed what Eritrea would need to use AI for development: skills, data systems, local-language tools and infrastructure. No policy or commitment came out of it. *Also under AI.*

- **Nigeria's Data Protection Audit Return: Blessing Udo advocates emulation** — BusinessDay, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA

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- **GouvNum : faire de la donnée et de l'intelligence artificielle des leviers de souveraineté numérique, de rationalisation budgétaire et de transformation de l'État** — Socialnetlink, 21 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

- **Citizen services project MyMzansi gets R150m boost** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's National Treasury is allocating R150 million to the Presidency's digital services unit to develop MyMzansi, a single platform for government services, according to the adjusted estimates released with the 2026 Medium-Term Budget Policy Statement. The first use case will be issuing and verifying digital matric certificates. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Data Exchange.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Equatorial Guinea: Service Quality a Priority for New Telecom Operator TELGESA** — Ecofin Agency, 21 October 2026 EQ. GUINEA

  Equatorial Guinea's authorities aim to sign an agreement before the end of October 2026 with investor group EGSA LOITA for a new telecom operator, TELGESA. The group has proposed USD 50 million for 260 towers to reach 90% national coverage, while KPMG values the assets of state operator GECOMSA. Launch before the end of 2026 remains uncertain. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **وزير الاتصالات: تصدر مصر ترتيب الدول الأفريقية في سرعة الإنترنت الثابت على مدار 6 سنوات متتالية** — تفصيلة (Tafsela), 21 October 2026 EGYPT

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- **TikTok blackout hits northern parts of Nigeria** — Connecting Africa, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

Data Storage

- **Nigeria Targets Faster Artificial Intelligence Development** — Voice of Nigeria, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA TOGO

  Opening the BUILD 2026 conference on shared compute in Abuja, Nigeria's communications ministry announced plans for a Nigeria–Togo data park and wider fibre connectivity. It also proposed a continental scheme for countries to pool computing power for AI research. *Also under AI and Technical Capacity.*

- **Burundi : Bujumbura explore avec Séoul un appui à son identité numérique** — wearetech.africa, 21 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Burundi's finance and digital economy minister, Alain Ndikumana, discussed cooperation on digital identification and authentication, data centres, secure hosting and linking government systems with South Korea's science and ICT ministry in Seoul. Financing through KOICA and Korea's Economic Development Cooperation Fund was explored. No agreement was reported. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data Exchange.*

- **وزير الاتصالات: تصدر مصر ترتيب الدول الأفريقية في سرعة الإنترنت الثابت على مدار 6 سنوات متتالية** — تفصيلة (Tafsela), 21 October 2026 EGYPT

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Technical Capacity

- **Nigeria Targets Faster Artificial Intelligence Development** — Voice of Nigeria, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA TOGO

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Cybersecurity

- **TNM engages Meta on WhatsApp hacks** — ITWeb Africa, 21 October 2026 MALAWI

  Malawian operator TNM said it has engaged Meta over reports of customers' WhatsApp accounts being compromised in Malawi and other countries. It said nothing shows its own systems were breached, and advised customers to turn on two-step verification.

- **Businesses urged to boost cyber defence measures** — The New Times, 21 October 2026 RWANDA

  Rwanda's National Cyber Security Authority and the Rwanda Development Board held a workshop for businesses in Kigali on 20 October 2026 on recovering from cyber attacks, as part of cybersecurity awareness month. Speakers urged layered defences, monitoring, recovery plans and checks on technology partners.

- **Bunge committee invites views on data protection** — Daily News (Tanzania), 21 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Citizen services project MyMzansi gets R150m boost** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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- **Burundi : Bujumbura explore avec Séoul un appui à son identité numérique** — wearetech.africa, 21 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Ethiopia Calls for Data-Driven Policymaking to Accelerate Africa's Progress** — Ethiopian News Agency, 21 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Opening the Statistical Commission for Africa in Addis Ababa, President Taye Atske Selassie said Ethiopia has reformed its statistics law and set up an independent statistical service. He put the country's mobile-money and mobile-banking accounts at 257 million, handling more than ETB 24 trillion in the first nine months of 2026. *Also under National statistics and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Biometrics, verification curb social grant fraud** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's National Treasury said in the 2026 Medium-Term Budget Policy Statement that better biometric enrolment and beneficiary verification, mostly on the social relief of distress grant, has saved R13.1 billion in social-grant fraud. It will apply similar checks to student bursaries and housing subsidies, and expects grant beneficiaries to fall from 17.8 million in 2026/27 to 17.1 million by 2029/30. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **IJG pitches mobile savings** — Market Watch Namibia, 21 October 2026 NAMIBIA

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

- **Burundi : Bujumbura explore avec Séoul un appui à son identité numérique** — wearetech.africa, 21 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **EdfaPay and GoPravo Launch SDPay to Expand Digital Payments in Sudan** — Tech Africa News, 21 October 2026 SUDAN

  Saudi payments firm EdfaPay and Sudanese IT company GoPravo launched SDPay, an equally owned joint venture based in Khartoum, to run payments infrastructure in Sudan. It plans merchant QR and card-terminal acceptance, wallets, card issuing, government collections, payroll and remittances, with digital ID and eKYC integration.

- **Somalia's House of the People Approves the Digital Transactions Bill with 137 Votes in Favour** — Ministry of Communications and Technology, Somalia (via Africa Newsroom), 21 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **NIBSS, Transactility's partnership delivers National Payment Stack** — Premium Times, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA

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- **Minister promises 'revised' draft of crypto assets regulation** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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- **Ethiopia Calls for Data-Driven Policymaking to Accelerate Africa's Progress** — Ethiopian News Agency, 21 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

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Registries

- **Going digital: Why MPs want land succession done digitally through E-Citizen** — Daily Nation, 21 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Sectoral management information systems

- **WHO and Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute Explore Strategic Collaboration to Advance AI for Health** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 21 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  A WHO delegation led by its representative to Ethiopia visited the Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute to explore a partnership on using AI in health systems, emergency preparedness and health security. The Institute showed locally built tools including language and translation software, disease-prediction models and AI skin-disease diagnostics. No agreement was reported. *Also under AI.*

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Tanzania Launches Digital Library System as Mkenda Urges Board to Prioritise Books Over Buildings - The Chanzo** — The Chanzo, 21 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania's education minister Adolf Mkenda launched the Integrated National Digital Library System, built by the Tanzania Library Services Board with the e-Government Authority, which handles registration, ISBN and ISSN applications, cataloguing, lending and billing on web and mobile. Copyright limits mean not every title will be online in full.

- **Gabon Launches Digital Platform to Modernize Parliamentary Work** — Tech Africa News, 21 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's National Assembly launched a Legislative Work Management Platform (GTLAN) on 19 October 2026 and issued tablets to members. The digital infrastructure agency ANINF trained members until 20 October on using it for committee review, government hearings and joint work on amendments.

- **Foreign Ministry launches pilot operation of e-platform for consular services for Egyptians abroad** — State Information Service (Egypt), 21 October 2026 EGYPT

  Egypt's foreign ministry has started piloting a mobile app for consular services for Egyptians abroad, covering 17 embassies and consulates at launch, with more to follow. Users can complete consular transactions in the app and track their progress.

- **Coopération Gabon–Chine : Modernisation de la Fonction publique et le renforcement des capacités** — Ministère de la Fonction Publique et du Renforcement des Capacités (Gabon), 21 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's civil-service minister asked China's ambassador for Chinese expertise in digitising public administration and training civil servants. The ambassador said China would look at what support it could give; no agreement is reported. *Also under China activities.*

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- **Biometrics, verification curb social grant fraud** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Technology

AI

- **Rwanda and South Korea explore cooperation in AI and digital infrastructure** — Tech Review Africa, 21 October 2026 RWANDA

  Rwanda's Minister of State for ICT and Innovation, Yves Iradukunda, met South Korea's Vice Minister of Science and ICT to discuss cooperation on AI, digital infrastructure and smart cities. No agreement was reported.

- **Namibia's first AI tutoring labs launched in Lüderitz** — Aitsa, 21 October 2026 NAMIBIA

Two AI tutoring labs, the first in a Namibian government school, opened at Angra Pequena Senior Secondary School in Lüderitz on 21 September 2026, funded with N$1.15 million from BW Kudu and Namport. Run by YYeni AI, they serve the school's 436 learners and 20 teachers, with six more schools in the ||Kharas region due to get labs in 2027. *Also under Literacy*.

- **WHO and Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute Explore Strategic Collaboration to Advance AI for Health** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 21 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Summarised under Sectoral management information systems.

- **SABS publishes draft AI standards for public comment** — Polity, 21 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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ICT Industry

- **Equatorial Guinea: Service Quality a Priority for New Telecom Operator TELGESA** — Ecofin Agency, 21 October 2026 EQ. GUINEA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Capacity

Literacy

- **NITDA Launches Digital Literacy Dashboard as Nigeria Records 2.7 Million Training Achievements** — Tech Africa News, 21 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's NITDA launched a National Digital Literacy Dashboard to track training and coordinate providers. It records about 2.77 million reported training achievements from 252 organisations over three years, across all 774 local government areas, led by Cisco, NITDA and Meta. It supports national targets of 70% digital literacy by 2027 and 95% by 2030.

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Data

National statistics

- **UBOS rejects new national data strategy, labels ICT Ministry launch 'illegal' and 'redundant'** — The Independent (Uganda), 21 October 2026 UGANDA

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- **Ethiopia Calls for Data-Driven Policymaking to Accelerate Africa's Progress** — Ethiopian News Agency, 21 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Geopolitics

China activities

- **Coopération Gabon–Chine : Modernisation de la Fonction publique et le renforcement des capacités** — Ministère de la Fonction Publique et du Renforcement des Capacités (Gabon), 21 October 2026 GABON

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Digital sovereignty

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EDITION	**2026-10-22**
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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.